Q & A: Ⅳ期

Make an Opinion!
Should've said that back then!!

（まず、質問を繰り返して...）

① (I think that) _____-Opinion-____ ← Thesis Statement（主張）
② because _____- Reason-____ ← Body 1（理由）
③ For example, _____- Example or Explanation- ← Body 2（具体例 or 説明）
④ (So my opinion is that) _____-Opinion-____ ← Conclusion（結論/主張）

①： I think (that)…
I feel (that)…
In my opinion…
In my view…

④： So, my opinion is that…
That's why I feel /think that…
Therefore, I would say…
In conclusion, I think…

②③：
○○ **is** important/ necessary/ useful/ helpful/ interesting/ entertaining/ exciting/
effective/ efficient / convenient / inexpensive / economical / fantastic

○○ **is** getting **more** (**and more**) important

It is important **for** us **to** develop / use ○○
It is *definitely* good **for** the environment/ our health/ children/ people/
perfectly OK our lives / our daily life / a good society / good relationships

social mobility/ human right(s)/ communication/ information (society)

So we <u>need</u> ○○ **to have/make** a better society
<u>should develop</u> ○○ **to make** our society much better
to address disparity/ disparities
to promote diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI)

Q 19:

Write an essay or story beginning with the following sentence.

"It was 6:00 in the morning on a day in November."

✅ A1 —

It was 6:00 *in the morning on a day in November*. I was sitting *up on the bed* and thought that another ordinary day had begun.

After a while, when I was having breakfast, I heard the door slam shut. That was because my husband had gone *outside the house*. *Then* I realized that he was going to take his 14-year-old dog, Momo-chan, *to the vet*. She had not eaten anything *for two days*.

When I came back *from work at noon*, my husband said that she was getting an IV drip *at the vet's*. *At that time*, he seemed to believe that she would get better *soon* and come *home*.

But the moment arrived *suddenly*. I got a phone call *from the doctor*. "Momo-chan passed *away a little while ago*," he said. We were very shocked.

In the afternoon, we went to pick her *up*. My husband wasn't able to control his tears while the doctor explained the process.

Momo-chan was my husband's dog, not mine. He had been taking care of everything *for her*.

When I was *in bed at night*, my eyes were filled with tears. Momo-chan, I would like to say thank you for coming *to our house* and taking care of my husband. (208 words)

🌟 Concise Feedback

Your writing is emotionally powerful and sincere. You used clear sequencing ("after a while," "at noon," "in the afternoon"), which makes the story easy to follow. The final message *to Momo-chan* is touching and ends the essay beautifully.

The main areas to keep working *on* are:

- verb tenses (past perfect: *had begun*, *had gone*)
- spelling (vet, realized, explained)
- avoiding small mistakes with articles and prepositions

But overall, the heart of the story is very strong.

💬 Encouragement for the Students

You expressed difficult emotions with honesty and warmth, which is not easy *in a second language*. Keep writing—each paragraph you write helps your grammar improve and your confidence grow. Your voice is clear, and your English will continue to become more natural with practice. Great work—please keep going!

🟦 電話する

📞 “call Tom” NEVER means 呼びかける .
It always means 電話する📞 .

I’ll call you later.(電話するね)

He called up his old friend. = He called his old friend up.

🟩 声で呼ぶ

I called out to Tom, but he didn’t hear me.(呼びかけたけど...)

🟨 名前を呼ぶ

I called Tom’s name, and he turned around.(~の名前を呼ぶと...)

👄 非難する

Tom lied, so I called him out in front of everyone.

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1. Ken に電話をする→ call Ken / call Ken *on the phone* / call Ken up

(old-fashioned / casual)

2. Ken に呼びかける→ call out to Ken / shout to Ken

3. Ken の名前を呼ぶ→ call Ken’s name / call his name, “Ken!”

/ call out his name, “Ken!” / shout Ken's name

4. "Ken!" と呼ぶ→ call, “Ken!” / call out, “Ken!”

✅ A2 —

It was 6:00 *in the morning on the 12th of November*. I went *to the hotel restaurant* to have breakfast. I had stayed *there the night before*. The hotel was close *to Nagoya Airport*. Several men *in dark suits* were *already* eating.

I knew *there* were some big companies *nearby* because I had noticed them when I checked *in last evening*. Most *of the guests* seemed to be businessmen. I had a Japanese-style breakfast and coffee. It tasted good, I remember thinking.

I hadn't slept well *the previous night*. I went *to bed at about 10:00*, but I had trouble falling asleep. Even so, I eventually slept, but I woke *up at 2:00 a.m*. I tried to calm *down* and sleep again but soon gave *up* and got *out of bed*.

My own fun trip — two nights and three days on Tsushima Island — was beginning *from Nagoya Airport that morning*.

(150 words)

⭐ Feedback for A2

What you did well:

- You wrote clearly *about your experience* and kept good chronological order.
- The details *about the businessmen, breakfast, and lack of sleep* created a realistic scene.

How to improve:

- Be careful with past tense consistency ("I knew," "I noticed," etc.).
- Try to combine short sentences for smoother flow.
- Avoid unnecessary prepositions like "near to."

Encouragement:
You have a strong foundation! Your storytelling is easy to follow, and with small adjustments to grammar, your writing will feel even more natural. Keep writing—you're improving steadily!

✅ **A3 —**
It was 6:00 *in the morning on a day in November*.
I woke *up to the sound of my alarm*. Normally, it would be an ordinary morning, but today was different.

I felt hot *under the futon* and kicked it *off*. Then I noticed my hands—they were covered *in black hair* and had long, sharp claws.
I stood *up* quickly and looked *in the mirror*. My whole body was covered *in black hair*.
I looked like a bear.
No—I *was* a bear.

As soon as I got *up*, I tried to call my husband, but I couldn't speak human language. Then I heard my son coming.

“What should I do?” I thought.
I hid *under the futon* and pretended to be asleep.

I thought maybe I should hibernate, because if I went *outside*, someone might kill me. And I hadn’t eaten enough food to survive the winter yet.

When I woke *up* again, I saw my husband’s worried face, and I realized it was *already* noon. (168 words)

⭐ Feedback for A3

What you did well:

- Very creative and fun storyline!
- You used clear emotional reactions (“What should I do?”) that make the story engaging.
- Excellent imagination and suspense.

How to improve:

- Watch verb tenses (“I stand up” → “I stood up”).
- Articles like *a/the* need careful attention.
- “Mirrow” → “mirror” and similar spelling corrections.

Encouragement:
This was such an entertaining and imaginative story! You have a talent *for creative writing*. *With more practice on grammar and spelling*, your storytelling ability will shine even more. Keep going—you’re doing great!

Marley: Learning Japanese is easier than learning English.

Tada: That may be true when it comes to speaking and listening, but reading and writing are a different story, though, aren't they?

Marley: Writing? Ah, oh... For speaking, Japanese feels easier *to me* because Japanese has fewer vowel sounds than English.

-Below are just fantasies about what I wish I could say.-

-（以下、こんなこと言えればいいのにって妄想っす）-

Tada: Ah, I see — you mean speaking-wise. That makes sense, especially when you think *about the vowel system*.

Pronouncing Japanese can feel less stressful than pronouncing English because *there* are fewer vowel sounds.

And *for you*, 'learning a language' usually starts *with the sound system* — listening and speaking, right?

In Japan, though, we tend *to approach* language learning *from the opposite direction*, starting *with reading and writing*, so that's the angle that I was coming *from*.

Q 20:

Write an essay or story titled “The Year 2026”

✅ A1 —

I’m going to talk *about* what I want to do *in 2026*. I’d like to keep studying *with all of you* and improve my English.

I wonder how many years have passed since we first met. Time goes *by* so fast. *At that time*, it was difficult *for me* to understand native English. However, little by little, I have started to get the hang *of it*.

Practice makes perfect.

I couldn’t have continued *without everyone*. I’m looking forward *to studying* together again *this year*. (84 words)

✅ **A2 —**

When the New Year countdown begins, I am finally alone, looking *back on the past year*.
However, I soon get sleepy and fall asleep.

A morning *without an alarm* comes *on New Year’s Day*.
In my bright room, I find myself *in the year 2026*.
I am thinking *about 2026* by myself.

My goal this year is to take the math test called "Suken." I'm excited to take it.

Every year, I set a goal and keep trying.
So *every year*, *there* is *always* something to do.

Next year, it might be better to set a goal to take a day *off*.

(102 words)

✅ A3 —

The year 2026 began.

First, I must take care of my health. *In February*, I will go *to the hospital* to have my stomach checked. I made a reservation. *Last April*, I found out that I had a polyp *in my stomach*. I hope it has not gotten worse.

In June, I have to renew my driver's license. That makes me unhappy. I'm not very good *at driving these days*. Maybe it is because of aging. I feel a little afraid.

So I wanted something happy. I decided to take a trip *to Portugal in October for one week*. I called a travel agent and reserved a women-only tour *with a private room and a tour guide*. *There* is still plenty of time, but I hope this trip will bring me happiness.

Let's enjoy life. (135 words)

Let us enjoy life. / Let us alone. / That makes me unhappy.

This trip will bring me happiness. / Give me chocolate.

"The storm *soon* spent its force." (Feels like classic English literature.)

→ In very modern casual English:

The storm *soon* died *down*.
The storm *quickly* lost its strength.

"The wild fire *soon* spent its force." Feels like 19th–early 20th c. writing.

→ In everyday modern conversation:

The wildfire *soon* burned *out*.
The wildfire was *quickly* brought *under control*.
The fire *soon* ran *out of* fuel.

Q 21:

Write an essay or story titled, "Kohaku Uta Gassen" or "The Showa era is long gone."

✅ A1 —

Kōhaku Uta Gassen

Kōhaku Uta Gassen is a TV program that takes place *once a year*.
For me, it is like Christmas or visiting a shrine *on New Year's Day*.

I have two reasons *for this feeling*.
The first reason is that my growth and life have become fond memories connected *with Kōhaku Uta Gassen*. For example, when I was a child, my friends and I *often* talked *about the program*. We each had our favorite singers.

The second reason is that *after the Tokyo Olympics in 1964*, many people watched TV *together* and were very happy to enjoy programs like Kōhaku Uta Gassen.
Therefore, I still look forward *to watching* this TV program *now*. (112 words)

✅ A2 —

Kōhaku Uta Gassen

I watched *Kōhaku Uta Gassen for the first time in years. Near the end of the show*, Kenshi Yonezu performed *with my favorite girl group*, ***HANA***. I was very excited to see them, but even more impressed by Kenshi Yonezu's voice.

After that, I looked him *up*, and a song called **"JANE DOE"** came *up*. It is the ending theme song of an animated movie, and he sang it as a duet *with the famous singer Hikaru Utada*. *After listening to the song*, I was almost *in tears*, even though I had not watched the movie. It was sad, painful, emotional, and also powerful. I was completely overwhelmed.

He is a very gifted musician to be able to *write* a song like this. *Recently*, I have been really *into this song*. However, I feel that watching the movie itself might be too painful *for me*. (145 words)

✅ A3 —

The Shōwa Era Is Long Gone

I was born *in the Shōwa era* and belong *to the baby boomer generation*. When I entered high school, I had to take very difficult entrance exams.

There were many students *at that time*. *After entering high school*, I realized that *there* were 50 students *in each class*, and *there* were 11 classes *in the first grade* (and 12 classes *in the second grade*). The school buildings were built *in the Meiji era*, and two additional prefabricated school buildings had been added.

Because *there* were so many students, we even went *on a school trip* using a chartered ship *for our school*. We traveled by ship *from Tanabe Port in Wakayama Prefecture to Ube Port in Yamaguchi Prefecture*. Then we visited Nagasaki and Beppu by bus, and finally returned *from Ōita Port to Tanabe through the Seto Inland Sea*. We truly enjoyed the trip.

Many, many years have passed *since then*. The Shōwa era is indeed long gone. (159 words)

Little

普通の L　　日本語のル　　Dark L

lead　/　feel

舌先:上歯茎↑左右の隙間から L　　舌先↑:上げた状態で L

a little　/　a little bit

↑ 舌:basic position で曖昧 ア　　舌先:上歯茎 ↑トゥ

star / start / street / strange

↑舌先:上歯茎 (母音入れない!)

It's a little bit strange.

↑ 舌先: 上歯茎で ツ　　サイ↑レント

I need a little bit of help.

However, little by little,
I have started to get the hang of it.

Maybe it is because of aging.
I feel a little afraid.

Q 22:

Do you agree or disagree with the following statement:

" Children and teenagers should not be allowed to use any social media *until they are 18 years old*."

Provide details and examples to explain your opinion.

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6. They should not be allowed to use the machine *until they are 18 years old*.

⇑

5. They should not be allowed to use the machine *in this age*.

⇑

4. They should be allowed to use the machine *in this age*.

⇑

3. They are allowed to use the machine *in this age*.

⇑

2. They are allowed to use the machine *in this age* by law.

⇑

1. The law allows them to use the machine *in this age*.

✏️ A1 —

I agree with the opinion that smartphones are bad *for children's lives*.
For example, smartphones damage their eyes and cause a lack of sleep. Also, they play with smartphones *all the time*, so they don't listen to what others are saying.

Furthermore, *there* is a lot of false information *on social media*. Children and teenagers have poor judgment, so they easily believe the information.

Therefore, children and teenagers should not be allowed to use any social media *until they are 18 years old*. (83 words)

✏️ A2 —

I agree.
"Children and teenagers should not be allowed to use any social media *until they are 18 years old*." I have two reasons.

The first reason is that they have little experience and knowledge and are likely to encounter dangerous problems. For example, they may be led *to dangerous sites* and become criminals.

The second reason is that they spend too much time *on social networking sites*, which can lead *to a variety of problems*. For example, if children primarily socialize

online, they will not develop important social skills that they will need *later in life*.

Therefore, children and teenagers should not be allowed to use any social media *until* *they are 18 years old*. (116 words)

✏️ A3 —

"Children and teenagers should not be allowed to use any social media *until* *they are 18 years old* ."
I completely agree.

They sometimes make irresponsible statements. They do not consider how other people feel. The content can lead *to bullying in school or society*. When a rumor comes *from them*, it may hurt someone.

Another problem is time differences. Social media connects people *all over the world*. For example, one boy *in Japan* plays *online* with another boy *in the U.S.A. or Europe*. Because of the time difference, he sleeps very little.

He wants to sleep *at school* *when* *he has to study*. His mother wants him to stop playing *in the middle of the night or early morning (5:00 a.m.)*, but he does not listen *to her advice*. She is worried *about him*. This situation continues.

So, *in this case*, I think she has to take the device *away from him*. Her son is only 12 years old. (159 words)

✏️ A4 —

No, I don't agree with this part of the statement: "any social media."
My point is that we should be careful when someone uses words like "all," "any," "absolute," or "never."

I don't care much whether the age is 18, 16, or even in the twenties. There are certainly some adults who shouldn't be allowed to use such things. Don't you think so? It's fine if you, as a parent, decide not to allow your children to use social media. But I strongly oppose forbidding everyone *from doing something*.

From the point of view of human rights, freedom of speech is one of the most important rights. We have to cherish it, and we must foster it *through education*. Social media are no exception—they are powerful tools *for expressing feelings, emotions, and opinions*.

Even children and teenagers should not be completely prevented *from using such tools*. A tool is just a tool—nothing more. The real issue is how we use it. Of course, as I mentioned, if some parents have a different opinion and choose not to allow it *in their own families*, that is fine. That is their responsibility. This is how we maintain balance *in society*.

Again, a tool is just a tool. The problem does not lie *in the tool itself*, but *in how we use it*. Therefore, I do not agree

with the statement. A liberal society can remain healthy only if freedom is protected. I would like to take part *in such a healthy and balanced society*. (254 words)

🎤 **1-Minute Speech**

No, I don't agree *with the statement*, especially the phrase "any social media." We should be careful *with extreme words like "all" or "never."*

I don't think age alone should decide this. Even some adults use social media irresponsibly. On the other hand, many young people can use it wisely. It's fine if parents choose to limit their own children, but I don't think we should forbid everyone.

From the point of view of human rights, freedom of speech is very important. Social media can be a powerful tool to express ideas and opinions. What matters is not the tool itself, but how we use it.

So, instead of banning social media, we should teach people how to use it responsibly. That is how we can build a healthy and balanced society. (132 words)

🎤 **1-Minute Speech (with Strong Opening & Closing)**

Imagine a world
where young people are not allowed to speak, share, or express themselves *online*
until they turn eighteen.
Is that really the kind of society we want?

No, I don't agree with the statement, especially the phrase "any social media."
We should be careful *with extreme words* like "all" or "never."

First of all, in this case, age alone should not decide it.
Even some adults use social media irresponsibly, while many young people can use it wisely.

Of course, It's fine if parents choose to limit their own children, but we should not forbid every kid.

Besides, from the point of view of human rights, freedom of speech is very important.
Social media can be a powerful tool to express ideas and opinions.
What matters is not the tool itself, but how we use it.

So, instead of taking voices *away*, let's learn and teach how to use our voices responsibly to foster the freedom of speech.
Because a healthy society is not built by silence— but by mutual understanding through dialogue. (175)

Q 23:

My favorite TV program / movie / YouTube etc.

✅ A1 —

My favorite TV program is (英雄たちの選択), “The Shape Course of History.” It is my number one favorite. I like history, and I am curious *about many different kinds of famous people*. I watch it *at 9:00 p.m. on Mondays on BS NHK*.

Another program I like is “Cats Walking in the World” (世界猫歩き). I always watch it and feel relaxed and healed *every time*.

I also like “Walking in the World Streets” (世界街歩き). I enjoy seeing places I have never visited *before*. I hope I can go *to those places someday*. (111)

✅ A2 —

I watch many different kinds of videos *on YouTube*. *Among them*, I like a channel *called* “*Bucket List*” It is run by a couple who want to work *on a global scale*.

They often post videos of their daily life. They have twin babies—one is a boy and the other is a girl. They are very

cute. Watching them eat is my favorite. They bang their hands *on the table* to ask *for food* quickly. I have been watching their videos since *they were in their mother's belly*. March 11th is their first birthday.

They have *already* traveled *abroad three times*, even though they are only one year old, because their parents are planning to move *overseas this year*. I'm looking forward to watching them speak English. (128)

✅ A3 —

My favorite movie is "Anne of Green Gables." I have been reading this story *since I was a child*. I have two reasons *for liking it*.

The first reason is its interesting story. A red-haired girl who was raised *in an orphanage* grows *into a woman* who is loved by everyone. She learns unconditional love *from her adoptive parents*, and they feel happy *watching her grow*. When I was a child, I wanted to be like Anne, but *now* I want to be like her adoptive mother, Marilla Cuthbert.

The second reason is the natural beauty *of Prince Edward Island*. It is known *for its breathtaking scenery*, such as red cliffs, green hills, and beautiful coastal views.

Therefore, I strongly recommend this movie. (123)

-ing vs to -

① You must be happy watching your son grow.
② You must be happy to watch your son grow.

👍 The real difference is meaning, not time

🔹 Core Difference
-ing = experience / process / in the middle of doing it
to - = about the idea or chance / plan / purpose

✅ ① You must be happy watching your son grow.

👉 Meaning:
You are experiencing it now.
You feel happy as you watch him grow day by day.

👉 Paraphrase:
→ You must be happy seeing him grow every day.

✅ ② You must be happy to watch your son grow.

👉 Meaning:
It is a happy thing/opportunity in general.
Slightly more objective / reflective

👉 Paraphrase:
→ You must be happy to have the chance to see him grow.

Q 24:

Write a short story about a character who overcomes a challenge or obstacle.